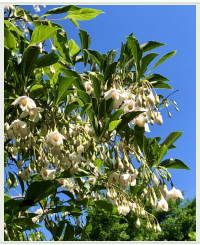
Japanese Snowbell

Styrax japonicus

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

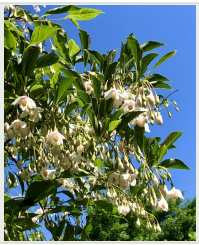
GARDENS Mirror Garden: 3 **TOTAL 3**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available



Flower
Library candidate

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Deciduous
Mature size: 20–30 ft (up to 50 ft). Confirmed by Missouri Botanical (20–30 ft). × 20–30 ft. Confirmed.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 5–9. Non-native (Japan, China, Korea). Small deciduous tree. Horizontal branching, pendulous white fragrant flowers. Attractive form. Performs well in Atlanta. Prefers acidic well-drained soil. Good specimen tree. Moderate growth. Fall color variable. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms 20–30 ft, horizontal branching, pendulous white flowers, moist acidic soils. Woodlanders lists Zones 5–8/9, 20–30 ft. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/styrax-japonicus/ ; https://woodlanders.net/products/styrax-japonicus]
Sun: Full sun to part shade.
Water: Medium. Prefers organically rich, medium moisture, well-drained.
Soil: Organically rich, acidic, well-drained preferred. Adaptable somewhat.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant in full sun to part shade in rich acidic well-drained soil. Water until established. Suitable as specimen tree. Attractive flowers and form. Minimal pruning (winter). Good for Atlanta landscapes. Attractive bark.
Soil prep: Organically rich, acidic, well-drained preferred. Adaptable somewhat.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Forest edges, secondary forests. East Asia. Elev. 400–1800 m.
Form / habit: Deciduous. Small tree. Compact with horizontal branching and rounded crown. Moderate growth.
Foliage: Yellow to red. Variable, often insignificant.
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Gray, fissuring to reveal orange inner bark on older branches. Attractive winter interest.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Generally durable. Possible minor issues. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence thin. No serious problems stated.
Not stated
Additional:
- Pendulous white fragrant flowers. - Horizontal branching. - Attractive bark. - Compact form. - Good specimen tree. - Variable fall color.